



Chris' Networking Rules

1. Don't sell or talk too much about yourself at networking meetings. Your goal is to build your sphere of influence by meeting new people who will educate you and become solid resources for your clients and pillars. This is not the time or place for a sales presentation.
2. Giving something is The best way to get something from networking. Do not expect to get leads when you never give others leads. Networking is like any relationship: You get out of it what you put in it.
3. Listen and ask the magic questions, "Susan, who is a great prospect or referral source for you? How can I succinctly describe what you offer to others?"
4. The people you meet are either: A- Potential clients or B- A source of referrals. Realize that not everyone will be a prospect. Networking is more than prospecting. It also involves finding people who could lead you to potential new customers or other referral sources.
5. Networking is more like farming than hunting. It takes time to cultivate and harvest. However, once the harvest season starts, you will be well compensated. We have seen professionals come only once or twice to a group event and then give up because they did not receive a lead. They do not realize they are being tested and judged by the long-time members for their "staying power."
6. Did you miss me, or am I just another number? Remember the first date you went on? You waxed the car. You put on your best clothing, shaved, or put make-up on. You opened the door for the other person. You paid him or her a compliment. But after you see them a few times, the extra efforts are gone. Keep all your meetings like the first one!
7. To quote Martien Eerhart, "Remember, it is net*work*, not net*eat* or net*play*.* Making the network work for you takes energy and effort."
8. Volunteer on the membership committee for trade groups of your best group of referral sources. Give of yourself, and people will find a way to send you business.
9. Keep track and take care of your "Super Pillars": those who have sent you 2+ leads in your life. With enough individuals in this category, you will be set for life.

I remember 20 years ago, I was president of a trade association, and I remember seeing two people I liked and respected across the room from each other. I grabbed them both and said, "You two need to know each other."

Fast forward almost 20 years, and now these people have become fast friends, and their families have even vacationed together. This gives me an unbelievably warm feeling of how that simple networking introduction changed their lives and led to many years of referrals for me.

For fast funding, please contact Chris Curtin at chris@bankersfactoring.com or toll-free at 866-598-4295.

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